

# **Katie Lynn Cantwell Butterfield**

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## **EDUCATION**

Ph.D. in Sociology (2021)

*University of California, Merced*

Dissertation: *Community Gardens, Structural Inequalities, & Health: From Participation to Representation*

Chair: Dr. Zulema Valdez

M.A. in Sociology (2016)

*University of California, Merced*

Thesis: *Effects of Racial & Class Neighborhood Composition on Community Garden Outcomes*

Chair: Dr. Zulema Valdez

## **RESEARCH INTERESTS**

Quantitative Methods; Sustainable Food Systems; Community Gardens; Food Access; Social Inequality; Rural Health; Health Disparities

## **TEACHING INTERESTS**

Introductory & Advanced Statistics, Research Methods, Data Presentation & Mapping, Health Disparities, Sociology of Food, Rural Sociology

## **RESEARCH TOOLS & SKILLS**

R, RStudio, ArcGIS, Qualtrics, STATA, QualCoder, SAS, ATLAS.ti, SQL, linear & logistic regression, structural equation modeling, multi-level modeling, geographic information system, spatial analysis & regression, online surveys, remote interviews, content analysis

## **RESEARCH EXPERIENCE**

Postdoctoral Researcher (Fall 2023 – Present)

*University of California, Davis – Agricultural Sustainability Institute*

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Ryan E. Galt

Lead a mixed-methods project exploring market data use/needs & pricing strategies in California's organic agrifood industry. Explore trends in adoption of organic food production across California.

*Supporting Grants:*

U.S. Department of Agriculture Agricultural Marketing Service (23-SCPMN-CA-0003)

University of California Multi-campus Research Programs & Initiatives (M25PR9207)

Research Data Analyst II (2021 – 2023)

*California Department of Social Services – CalFresh & Nutrition Branch*

Tracked various quantitative metrics & led multiple quantitative projects that directly informed leadership's work to improve equitable food access in California, including a multi-level modeling analysis of the effectiveness of county business practices.

Graduate Student Researcher (Spring 2021)

*University of California, Merced*

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Zulema Valdez

Supported the curation of web resources on faculty diversity in hiring & retention & the development of assessment tools & evaluative research for related programs.

Staff Research Associate (Summer 2020)

*University of California, Merced*

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Whitney Pirtle

Drafted a structural equation model to clarify how racial identity mediates the relationship between racial discrimination & poor health.

Staff Research Associate (Summer 2015; Summer 2019)

*University of California, Merced*

Academic Supervisor: Dr. Zulema Valdez

Led a mixed-methods project exploring the experiences & values of community gardeners & the perceived health impacts of their garden participation.

Graduate Student Researcher (Fall 2017)

*University of California, Merced*

Academic Supervisor: Dr. A Susana Ramirez

Performed factor analysis & linear & logistic regressions to assess the relationship between perceptions of neighborhood health & attributions of health responsibilities.

Staff Research Associate (Spring 2015)

*University of California, Merced*

Academic Supervisors: Dr. Nella Van Dyke & Dr. Kyle Dodson

Collected & cleaned missing values from a nation-wide historical dataset on hate crimes & related laws. Compiled & prepared data for analysis.

## **PUBLICATIONS**

Butterfield, Katie L., & Ryan E. Galt. 2026. "New Estimates Show the First Decline in California's Organic Share of Cropland." *California Agriculture: The Journal of University of California Agriculture & Natural Resources* 80(September). doi:[10.3733/001c.167210](https://doi.org/10.3733/001c.167210).

- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. 2026. "Improving USDA's Public Price & Volume Data for an Equitable Organic Food Value Chain." *Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, & Community Development* 15(3):1–24. doi:[10.5304/jafscd.2026.153.013](https://doi.org/10.5304/jafscd.2026.153.013).
- Butterfield, Katie L., & Kathryn P. Daniels. 2025. "Community Gardens Support Stress Coping & Health – A Comparison of Rural & Urban Perceptions of Benefits." *Wellbeing, Space & Society*. doi:[10.1016/j.wss.2025.100297](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.wss.2025.100297).
- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. 2024. *Organic Data Initiative Gap Analysis – California*. University of California, Davis, Agricultural Sustainability Institute & University of California Organic Agriculture Institute.
- Butterfield, Katie L. 2023. "Modeling Community Garden Participation: How Locations & Frames Shape Participant Demographics." *Agriculture & Human Values* 40:1067–85. doi: [10.1007/s10460-022-10406-2](https://doi.org/10.1007/s10460-022-10406-2).
- Marin, Nefertari, Brittany Oakes, & Katie Butterfield. 2021. "[Changing the World with Community Gardens: A study of community gardens & community garden nonprofits across the United States](#)". ArcGIS Online Story Map
- Butterfield, Katie L., & A. Susana Ramírez. 2021. "Framing Food Access: Do Community Gardens Inadvertently Reproduce Inequality?" *Health Education & Behavior* 48(2):160–68. doi: [10.1177/1090198120950617](https://doi.org/10.1177/1090198120950617).
- Butterfield, Katie L. 2020. "Neighborhood Composition & Community Garden Locations: The Effect of Ethnicity, Income, & Education" *Sociological Perspectives* 63(5):738–63. doi: [10.1177/0731121420908902](https://doi.org/10.1177/0731121420908902).

## MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. "Pricing Decisions & Power Dynamics in California's Organic Agrifood Industry."
- Butterfield, Katie L. "Fundamental Cause Theory & Community Gardens: Evidence of Countervailing Mechanisms"
- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt "Organic Production Across California: 2007 – 2022"
- Butterfield, Katie L., Ryan E. Galt, & Houston Wilson. "Data-Informed Decision-Making in California's Organic Agrifood System."
- Butterfield, Katie L. with Brittany Oakes & Zulema Valdez. *All Things to All People: Community Gardens in the United States*. (monograph)

## **TEACHING EXPERIENCE**

Teaching Fellow / Instructor of Record (2018 – 2020)

*University of California, Merced*

Introduction to Sociology (Summer 2018; Summer 2019; Summer 2020)

This course provides an introduction to applying the “sociological imagination” & exploring how individual behaviors are influenced by society.

Statistics for Sociology (Spring 2019; Spring 2020)

This course introduces the logic & use of statistical techniques in social research, including descriptive, comparative, & inferential statistics, & the use of applicable software (SPSS, SAS).

Advanced Race & Ethnicity (Fall 2018; Fall 2019)

This course examines in depth the main classical & modern explanations of the issues surrounding race & ethnicity.

Sociology of Race & Racism (Spring 2018)

This course provides insight into how race & racism define our lives through systemic & structural racism, racial categorization, ethnic identification, nativism, & intersecting oppressions.

Teaching Assistant (2014 – 2017)

*University of California, Merced*

Graduate Statistics I (Spring 2017)

This course in social statistics is required of graduate students in Sociology & takes a systematic approach to the general linear model for continuous dependent variables.

Sociological Research Methods (Spring 2016)

This course provides students with a basic understanding of how to conduct social science research.

Statistics for Sociology (Spring 2015, Fall 2016)

This course introduces the logic & use of statistical techniques in sociological research.

Advanced Race & Ethnicity (Fall 2015)

This course examines in depth the main classical & modern explanations of the issues surrounding Race & Ethnicity.

Introduction to Sociology (Fall 2014)

This course introduces the study of groups, culture, collective behavior, classes & caste, community & ecology, role, status, & personality.

## **PRESENTATIONS**

- 2026 “Tracking organic agriculture is easier said than done” with Ryan E. Galt, 2026 American Association of Geographers Annual Meeting
- 2026 “Data & Democracy” with Ryan E. Galt, Soledad Castro, & Santiago Alvarez, 2026 American Association of Geographers Annual Meeting, organized paper session
- 2025 “Pricing Decisions & Power Dynamics in California’s Organic Agrifood Industry” with Ryan E. Galt & Houston Wilson, Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2025 “California Organic, Agroecological, & Regenerative (COAR) Transitions Project: Trends in Organic Agriculture in California, 1992-2022” with Ryan E. Galt, Jahalel Lee Tuil, & Kase Wheatley, EcoFarm, poster presentation
- 2024 “California Organic, Agroecological, & Regenerative (COAR) Transitions Project: Trends in Organic Agriculture in California, 1992-2022” with Ryan E. Galt, Jahalel Lee Tuil, & Kase Wheatley, California Climate & Agriculture Summit, poster presentation
- 2024 “All Things to All People: Community Gardens in the United States” with Brittany Oakes & Zulema Valdez, Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society, poster presentation
- 2024 “California Organic Data Collection Gap Analysis” Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2021 “Community Gardening in the United States” with Brittany Oaks & Zulema Valdez, Grow Grant Conference
- 2021 “Community Garden Accessibility: Impacts of Frames & Locations” Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2021 “Community Gardening in the United States” with Brittany Oaks & Zulema Valdez, Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society
- 2019 “Community Gardens, Investments, & Health Outcomes” American Sociological Association Annual Meeting, Round Table 26. Places, Housing, & Health
- 2019 “Health Benefits of Urban Vs. Rural Community Gardens” Annual Meeting of the Rural Sociology Society
- 2019 “Community Gardens, Structural Inequalities, & Health: Urban Vs. Rural Community Gardens” Annual Conference of the Agriculture, Food & Human Values Society

- 2016 “The Effects of Racial & Class Neighborhood Composition on Community Garden Outcomes” Annual Meeting of the American Public Health Association, poster presentation
- 2016 “Straddling Two Worlds: Does Visiting Home Help or Harm First Generation Students' College Engagement?” with Irene Beattie & Wendy Puquirre. Annual Conference of the Sociology of Education Association
- 2015 “The Effects of Race & Class on Community Garden Locations” Annual Meeting of the Pacific Sociological Association

### **INVITED TALKS**

- 2026 “Improving USDA’s Public Price & Volume Data for an Equitable Organic Food Value Chain” with Ryan E. Galt & Houston Wilson, Organic Pricing Data webinar, Rodale Institute
- 2026 “Organic Data Recommendations” with Ryan E. Galt, Krista Marshall, Neha Sanghera. & Vivian Wauters, California Organic Products Advisory Committee Sep 2026 meeting
- 2026 “Careers Beyond Academia Panel” University of California, Merced, Sociology Graduate Student Committee, Professional Development Panel
- 2018 “Community Gardens, Inequality, & Health” University of California, Merced, Blum Center Summer Institute
- 2017 “Race, Class, & Community Garden Locations” Lyceum Lunchtime Speaker Series, University of California, Merced Health Sciences Research Institute

### **FELLOWSHIPS & GRANTS**

- 2021 University of California, Merced, Global Food Initiative Campus Collaborative Grow Grant
- 2015-2019 Summer Sociology Graduate Student Support Award
- 2018 University of California, Merced, Blum Center Seed Funding
- 2015-2017 Sociology Graduate Student Travel Award
- 2016 University of California Global Food Initiative Fellowship
- 2015 John & Victoria Elia Fellowship

### **AWARDS & CERTIFICATES**

- 2016 & 2020 University of California, Merced, Graduate Division Winter Dissertation Writing Boot Camp

|      |                                                                                                                                                                                    |
|------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2019 | Sociology Graduate Student Service Award                                                                                                                                           |
| 2019 | Sociology Conference Paper Presentation Award                                                                                                                                      |
| 2015 | University of California, Merced, Center for Research on Teaching Excellence<br>Certificate in General Pedagogy: Mastering the Classroom with First Generation<br>College Students |
| 2015 | Inter-University Consortium for Political & Social Research Summer Program in<br>Quantitative Methods of Social Research Workshop: Intro to Spatial Regression<br>Analysis         |

## **SERVICE**

|              |                                                                                                                                           |
|--------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025-Present | Reviewer, Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, & Community Development                                                                   |
| 2023-Present | Reviewer, Agriculture & Human Values                                                                                                      |
| 2023-Present | Reviewer, Urban Forestry & Urban Greening                                                                                                 |
| 2025         | Reviewer, Environmental Evidence                                                                                                          |
| 2025         | Reviewer, Journal of Hunger & Environmental Nutrition                                                                                     |
| 2025         | Reviewer, Acta Sociologica                                                                                                                |
| 2019-2021    | Organizer, University of California Community Economies Network                                                                           |
| 2020-2021    | Volunteer, Code for America                                                                                                               |
| 2018-2019    | Internal Graduate Student Representative, Sociology Graduate Student<br>Committee, University of California, Merced                       |
| 2017-2019    | Graduate Student Representative, Healthy Campus Network Committee,<br>University of California, Merced                                    |
| 2017-2018    | President, Sociology Graduate Student Committee, University of California,<br>Merced                                                      |
| Fall 2017    | Volunteer, Insight Garden Program                                                                                                         |
| Fall 2016    | Graduate Student Representative, Faculty Senate Committee on Academic<br>Planning & Resource Allocation, University of California, Merced |
| Fall 2016    | Academic Affairs Officer, Graduate Student Association, University of<br>California, Merced                                               |
| 2015-2016    | Sociology Delegate, Graduate Student Association, University of California,<br>Merced                                                     |

## **MEMBERSHIPS**

|                  |                                           |
|------------------|-------------------------------------------|
| 2017-Present     | Agriculture, Food, & Human Values Society |
| 2017-Present     | Caucus of Women in Statistics             |
| 2026             | American Association of Geographers       |
| 2016-2019        | Rural Sociological Association            |
| 2014-2016 & 2019 | American Sociological Association         |
| 2015-2016        | Pacific Sociological Association          |